Sebastian Russo

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Education

Stanford University, Computer Science BS (AI), MS (Systems & AI) *(on leave)* Sept 2021 – June 2025

- **GPA:** 3.8/4.0
- **Coursework:** Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Natural Language Processing, Computer Networking, Computer Security, Operating Systems, AI Agents & Simulations, AI Principles & Techniques, Nonfiction Writing

Experience

Research PM, **Google DeepMind** – Mountain View, CA Sept 2025 – Present

- Code post-training PM, Gemini 3.5-3.8 Flash & Gemini 4; Lead PM, EmbeddingGemma
- **Evals:** Supported 1P eval development across mid- & post-training – Antigravity (web-dev & vibecoding tasks) & google3 (SWE tasks)
- **Data:** Managed $XXM in RL/SFT code-data spend; owned vendor selection & quality bar across 4 providers
- **Judges:** Led LM-judge design (e.g., cheating, tool usage, instruction following) & built in-IDE feedback tooling collecting O(1000s) of behavior samples to inform behavior-autorater improvement & checkpoint selection

Machine Learning Research, **Stanford Autonomous Agents Lab** – Stanford, CA Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

- Supported research on machine creativity & evaluation of open-ended domains (e.g., creative writing) in Stanford's Autonomous Agents Lab (SAIL), mentored by Dr. Nick Haber
- Investigated verification methods for open-domain tasks & designed evaluations for LM-based verifiers

Associate Product Manager Intern, **Google** – Mountain View, CA June 2024 – Sept 2024

- Shipped model tuning (post-training) features for 1P LLM agent platform (5k MAUs), improving agent quality
- Designed & socialized P0 use cases, entry points, & strategy for agent orchestration MVP in Enterprise Chrome

Course Assistant, **Stanford Computer Science Dept.** – Stanford, CA Jan 2024 – Jun 2025

- CS 106A/B – two-quarter introductory computer science sequence in Python & C++

Strategy Intern, **Uber** – San Francisco, CA June 2023 – Sept 2023

- Built product roadmap streamlining Eng information discoverability across 5 platforms for 20k users

Publications & Projects

LitBench: A Benchmark and Dataset for Reliable Evaluation of Creative Writing 2026
Presented at EACL 2026 (2nd author) | [arXiv] [data] [code]

- Stanford Autonomous Agents Lab
- First benchmark for creative-writing evaluation: 2.5k human-labeled story comparisons & a 43k-pair training corpus, with implicit preference labels sourced from Reddit
- Built the LM-as-judge harness & fine-tuned Bradley-Terry & generative reward models

Gemini Embedding 2: A Native Multimodal Embedding Model from Gemini 2026
[arXiv]

- Contributed to DeepMind's native multimodal (video/audio/image/text) embedding model.

Icebreakers: Simulating Social Behavior with LMs 2024
[website]

- Multi-agent simulator (Next.js, OpenAI API, Prisma/Postgres) comparing LM-agent behavior across social scenarios (e.g. gamification, leadership) to optimize cooperation & engagement

Etc.

Technical: Python, PyTorch, C/C++, SQL, Go, JavaScript/React, Figma, git

ML/AI: LM-as-judge design, reward modeling (Bradley-Terry, generative RMs), RLHF/RLVR, autorater design, eval design

Writing: Essays at sebrusso.substack.com – recently *AAA: Automobiles, America, Ancestry*